

Foreword

BY JILL CATALDO

My passion for couponing began innocently enough. Like most people, I used coupons occasionally, clipping a few from the Sunday paper and trying to save a few dollars here and there. My transformation from casual coupon user to consumer coupon expert could quite possibly be traced to a single tube of toothpaste.

When I was pregnant with our third child, I became driven to save more money. I started paying closer attention to sales cycles at stores, and one week I noticed that toothpaste was on sale for a dollar. I happened to have a coupon for a dollar off the toothpaste, and the coupon made the toothpaste free.

All couponers have had their own “light bulb” moment—the first deal that begins a shift in the way you look at shopping and saving. Mary Potter Kenyon’s moment just came a little earlier than most. As you will read in *Coupon Crazy*, she was ten years old when she sat at the kitchen table reading the back of a cereal box and realized she wanted to be one of those people who got things free. For me, that single tube of toothpaste was my epiphany. And from that moment forward, I became a better, smarter, and more strategic shopper. Matching coupons to sales and taking products home at the lowest possible prices was fun—almost addicting—and I reveled in the money that I was saving. Soon, I was teaching others to save via live workshops, a blog, and a nationally-syndicated column.